

Inventions

The 20th century was a period of great technological change. The world's first airplane, first rocket, and first satellite were all in the sky by 1957. Toward the beginning of the 21st century, computers and cell phones transformed the world. Today, new inventions continue to improve human life.



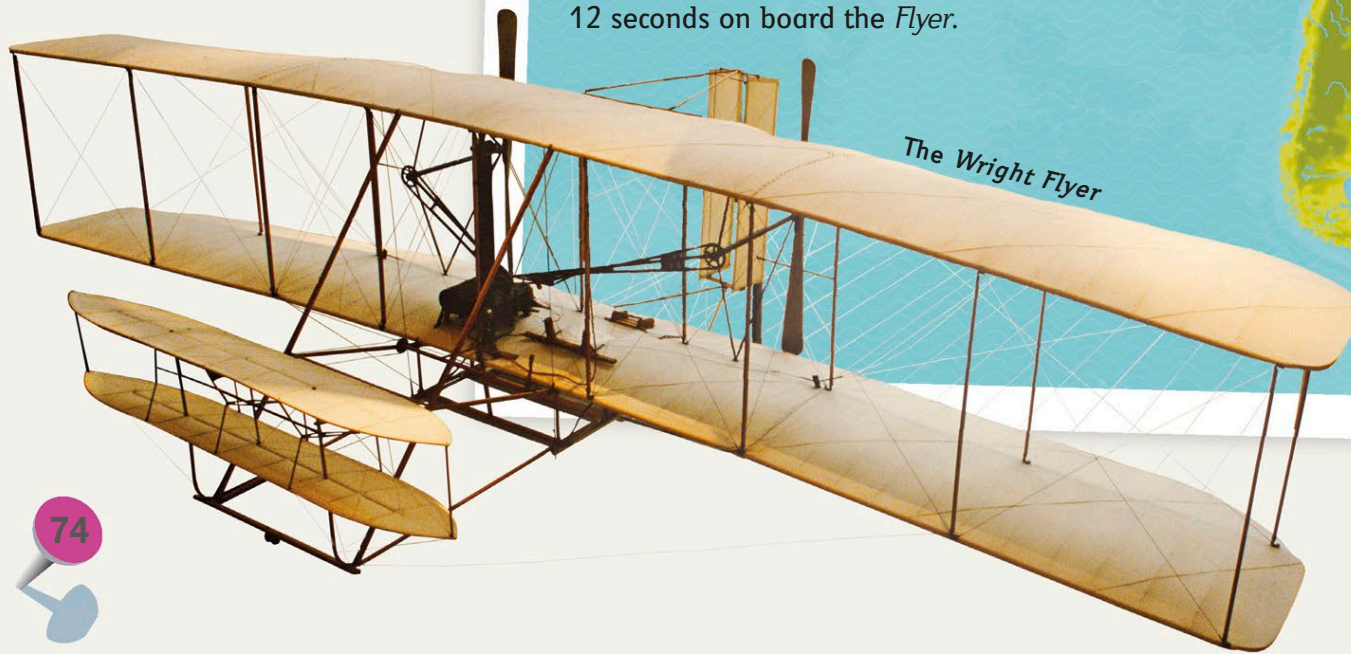
UNIVAC, an early computer

The computer revolution

The first computers, created in the 1940s, were huge machines that worked slowly. Today's computers are small, fast, and can do many different things. Modern computers have changed the way we work, live, learn, and entertain ourselves.

Taking to the skies

Orville Wright was the first person to make a powered flight, above North Carolina in 1903. Thanks to the development of powerful gas engines, he flew 120 feet (37 m) in 12 seconds on board the *Flyer*.



The Wright Flyer

The world's first personal computer was designed and developed by IBM in California in 1973.

First personal computer

In 1958, Jack Kilby created a tiny electronic circuit called a microchip. This changed the way technology was powered.

First integrated circuit (microchip)

First handheld cell phone

First electronic computer

Martin Cooper developed the world's first cell phone in 1973. It was about the size of a brick.

ENIAC, the world's first electronic computer, was built in Pennsylvania in 1946.

NORTH AMERICA

SOUTH AMERICA

PACIFIC OCEAN

ATLANTIC OCEAN